

● ASSIGNED — ● BOARD — ● EVIDENCE — ● SOLVE — ● CLOSE — ● REPORT



Marketing **Detective** Agency

A campaign has gone wrong somewhere out there, and the client wants answers. Open the case file, walk the evidence board, and name the mistake before the trail goes cold.

CASE FILE

CONFIDENTIAL

Click to receive your **next assignment**

CAMPAIGN OBJECTIVE

Drive holiday sales while reinforcing the brand's sustainability positioning.

Audience note: Environmentally conscious shoppers aged 20-38.

CHANNELS & BUDGET

Influencers	45%
Paid social	35%
Email	20%

CAMPAIGN METRICS

Reach	2.1M
CTR	2.6%
Engagement	4.0%
Conversions	0.5% then declining
Sales	\$52K then refund spike

CUSTOMER COMMENTS

"Turns out their 'recycled' fabric is barely 10% recycled, read the report."

"Called out for greenwashing on a sustainability blog, yikes."

"Returning mine, don't want to support false advertising."

SOCIAL PERFORMANCE

Twitter/X	Negative
Sustainability blog thread	40K views
Instagram	Negative
Comment sentiment	flipped negative within 48 hours

MARKETING CHANNELS

- Influencer campaign
- Paid social
- Email

SUPPORTING CLUES

Tap each tab in order to pull the next clue from the file.



An independent sustainability blog published a detailed breakdown showing the 'recycled' claim was far weaker than advertised.

Refund requests spiked directly after the blog post gained traction, not before.

Comment sentiment across social channels flipped from positive to negative within 48 hours of the exposé.

?

All clues gathered.

SOLVE THE CASE

NAME THE MARKETING MISTAKE

Based on the evidence board, which one of these best explains what went wrong for EcoThreads Apparel?

A. Marketing claims about sustainability overstated the product's actual environmental practices, and independent fact-checking exposed the gap, triggering a greenwashing backlash.

B. The win-back campaign treated all churned users the same, ignoring the specific reasons — mostly pricing complaints — that were already on record.

C. The campaign had no defined target audience, so the message tried to speak to everyone and resonated with no one.

D. Influencers repeated unverified 'clinically proven' claims without disclosure or evidence, triggering a credibility backlash once audiences fact-checked the campaign.

BACK TO BOARD

FILE REPORT

CORRECTLY SOLVED

CASE DEBRIEF - ECOTHREADS APPAREL

EcoThreads' campaign leaned hard on a sustainability claim that didn't match the product's actual composition. Once an independent source verified the gap, the same audience the brand courted for its values felt misled, and the backlash spread faster than the original campaign.

SUGGESTED IMPROVEMENTS

- Ensure every sustainability claim is independently verifiable before it's used in marketing.
- Be specific and transparent about percentages and sourcing rather than using vague eco-language.
- Have a rapid, honest response plan ready for when claims are publicly challenged.

FINAL CAMPAIGN SNAPSHOT

Influencers	45%
Paid social	35%
Email	20%

TAKE ANOTHER CASE